

Identifying and Developing Transferable Skills

Understand What the Target Career Field Demands

- Research skills valued by the target field:
 - Vault Guides (Alumni = A-Z Career Research Databases; E/W = Search Career Databases)
- Function-specific resume grids:
 - Alumni = Career Services > Changing Companies, Functions, and Industries > Resumes and Cover Letters
 - E/W = Careers > Market & Prepare Yourself > Write a Resume
- Job postings:
 - GTS
 - External career websites like Indeed.com
- Bios and LinkedIn profiles of people in the field
- Tapping into your network
- Student or Professional or Associations

Know Your Skills

- Document your skills using:
 - Self-assessment tools that you have taken at work and/or school
 - Performance reviews
 - Resume

Translate Your Skills in Ways the Target Career Field Values

- Explore how others have translated their skills valued by the target field:
 - Function-specific resume grids
 - Job postings
 - GTS historical resume database
 - People in the field
 - Career Changers

Develop Additional Skills to Bridge Any Gaps

- Analyze the gaps in your skills:
 - Hard skills – model building, strategy planning, and accounting. What else?
 - Soft skills – leading, mentoring, and communication skills. What else?
 - Technical skills – software coding, building prototypes, and statistics. What else?
 - Job specific skills –building features for a new phone, managing a plant, and conducting feasibility studies for entering a new market. What else?

Find ways to bridge the gaps in:

- Current role
- Working on projects outside of your department
- A new job
- In a start-up

- Volunteer work
- Classes
- Professional Association meetings and conferences (e.g. CFA Institute)

Next Steps

- Document your skills
- Research skills valued by the target field
- Explore how others have translated their skills valued by the target field
- Analyze the gaps in your skills
- Find ways to bridge the gaps

Resources:

Online:

- Vault Guide (Alumni = A-Z Career Research Databases; E/W = Search Career Databases)
- Self-assessment Exercises:
 - Alumni = Career Services > Changing Companies, Functions, and Industries > Self-Assessment
 - E/W = Careers > Get Started > Take a Self-Assessment
- Industry Information:
 - Alumni = Career Services > Conduct Research > Research an Industry
 - E/W = Careers > Research Career Components > Research Industries & Roles
- Function Information:
 - Alumni = Career Services > Conduct Research > Research a Function
 - E/W = Careers > Research Career Components > Research Industries & Roles
- Function-specific Resumes
 - Alumni = Career Services > Changing Companies, Functions, and Industries > Resumes and Cover Letters
 - E/W = Careers > Market & Prepare Yourself > Write a Resume

Books (Fisher Career Resource Center):

- *Drive: The Surprising Truth About What Motivates Us* – Daniel Pink
- *Knock 'em Dead: The Ultimate Job Search Guide* – Martin Yate CPC
- *What Color Is Your Parachute? 2019: A Practical Manual for Job-Hunters and Career-Changers* – Richard N. Bolles

CareerCast (<https://www.chicagobooth.edu/careercast>)

- *Reinventing Your Career and Your Life* – Steve Olsher

Other

- Questions? Contact Career Services by email at boothworks@ChicagoBooth.edu or by calling 312-464-8677.